

My son pays for an app that makes his videos look like VHS.

I said I could build it for free.

He said no. Then he wrote the spec.

**“It's not the static.
It's how it moves.
Sometimes it warps.”**

His exact words. Better than most tickets I've been handed.



Not an overlay. Every frame degrades the way tape actually degrades.

THE SPEC

His objection became the requirement list.

Every scanline drifts on its own, recomputed every frame.

Glitch bands crawl up the picture and let go.

Color bleeds sideways. Tape stored color at a fraction of the resolution.

A date stamp bottom right, where 90s camcorders put it.

tapewarp

About 300 lines. numpy and ffmpeg. No AI model, no cloud, no subscription.

He conceded. That was the expensive part.

```
$ python tapewarp.py clip.mov --wear worn  
# rented twice a week since 1992  
$ python tapewarp.py clip.mov --wear trashed  
# found in a flooded basement
```

A paid app became one readable file in a weekend.

Most businesses are full of these.

The report someone assembles by hand every Monday.

The renaming. The reformatting.

The subscription everyone pays for and uses ten percent of.

Those are one file too.

Got old family footage?

Run it through and send me what comes out. I want to see it.